



GALA DINNER

Power Punch

Kee your boarding cards ready, called out a voice in the queue for General Pervez Musharraf's dinner. Indeed, from Delhi, Mumbai and Bangalore, everyone seemed to be set for take-off. Sunil and Nyna Mittal had cancelled a dinner to be at the keynote address at the India Today Conclave, Vikram and Geetanjali Kirloskar had flown in from Bangalore, and Adi and Parmeshwar Godrej were all ears. If Musharraf was disappointed that Shah Rukh Khan, with his shoulder in a sling, didn't stay to listen to him, the star quipped, "not as disappointed as we are in him".

It was two days of intellect, insight and experience. Star speakers mingled with A-list guests, as power lunches blended into cosy cocktails. Omar Abdullah flew in from Srinagar with his wife, the stunningly poised Payal. Everyone, from the Ranbaxy brothers Malvinder and Shivinder Singh to former home secretary Vinod Duggal, wanted to meet him, to do business as much as to congratulate the new great hope of Kashmir. "I hope I can meet all the expectations," said Omar modestly. On Day 2, his father Farooq Abdullah said a few home truths to the former general, making it a father-son sweep. Several